Best Ball Butts 2026: Week 8 outlook

As of 2026-10-28. Weeks 1–7 are final and locked in; Week 8 starts Thursday. The numbers are the average of 12 season simulations (6 projection sources × 2 noise models, 8,000 seasons each) on the real schedule, best-ball scoring and Sleeper's 6-team bracket.

TL;DR

- **Noelle pulls ahead at 25.2% (was 21.9%)** after beating Raghav. She is 1st in 7 of 12 runs and 2nd in the other 5, with a 60.4% bye chance.
- **Ben (19.9%), Conrad (18.0%) and Emma (17.6%) are bunched behind her.** Emma drops 3.1 after losing to Conrad, who has now won four straight.
- **Raghav is 5-2 but falls to 9.5%; Henry slides to 5.2% at 1-6.** Lauren 4.6%, Avery 0.0% (last in all 12 runs).

Standings odds

#	Manager	Rec	PF	Title %	Range	Playoff %	Bye %	Prior edition (Oct 21)	Δ
1	**Noelle**	5-2	1295.4	**25.2**	21–34	99.0	60.4	21.9	+3.3
2	Ben	5-2	1302.5	19.9	16–23	98.4	53.2	17.9	+1.9
3	Conrad	4-3	1257.9	18.0	9–26	96.1	29.2	16.1	+1.8
4	Emma	4-3	1323.5	17.6	9–29	95.0	29.4	20.8	−3.1
5	Raghav	5-2	1194.6	9.5	5–17	93.7	21.4	11.8	−2.3
6	Henry	1-6	1239.8	5.2	4–8	40.3	0.7	8.4	−3.2
7	Lauren	4-3	1186.3	4.6	2–9	76.9	5.7	3.0	+1.6
8	Avery	0-7	1115.2	0.0	0–0.1	0.5	0.0	0.1	0.0

What changed since last week

- **Week 7:** Lauren beat Henry (188.9–172.5), Ben beat Avery (177.7–144.3), Noelle beat Raghav (173.4–150.5) and Conrad beat Emma (172.7–148.9). Joe Burrow (Ben) had the week's top score at 36.9, ahead of Tony Pollard (36.5) and Drake Maye (32.4), both Henry's.
- **New injuries:** Tyrone Tracy Jr. (Ben) went on IR with a hamstring injury (earliest return Week 13). Jaylen Waddle (Ben) left Week 7 with a chest injury, Saquon Barkley (Avery) re-tweaked his hamstring, and Aaron Jones (Raghav) re-aggravated his MCL.
- **Still out:** Terry McLaurin (Emma) for the season, Romeo Doubs (Noelle) on IR through at least Week 10, Alec Pierce (Noelle) through Week 9 and Jonathon Brooks (Emma) through Week 9.
- **Close to returning:** Lamar Jackson (Emma) is expected to play in Week 8. Breece Hall (Henry) is back at limited practice. Deebo Samuel and Travis Etienne (both Raghav) have a chance to return after the Week 8 bye.
- **Moves:** Conrad claimed KC Concepcion Jr. for 131 FAAB (dropping Kyler Murray) and switched to the Chiefs and Commanders D/STs. Henry claimed Caleb Douglas for 122 (dropping Rashid Shaheed) and added Alvin Kamara and Seth McGowan. Raghav claimed Tank Dell for 20.

Team by team

- **Noelle (25.2%):** 5-2 and 1st or 2nd in all 12 runs; the production source rates her highest (31–34%). Doubs and Pierce are out, and Charbonnet, Price and Moore are Week 8 questions.
- **Ben (19.9%):** 5-2 and 2nd in points, with the tightest range of the contenders (16–23%). Tracy's IR stint and Waddle's chest injury thin his depth.
- **Conrad (18.0%):** 4-3 after four straight wins, and the ESPN source's favorite (25–26%). Warren and Love are Week 8 questions; Tyson is still on IR.
- **Emma (17.6%):** 4-3 with the most points (1323.5), and the Sleeper source's favorite (24–29%). The market and production sources rate her 9–13%, mostly because McLaurin is gone for the year.
- **Raghav (9.5%):** 5-2 but 6th in points, and 6th at 6.6% with the record removed. Jones, McConkey and Pierce are Week 8 questions before Samuel and Etienne can return.

- **Henry (5.2%):** 1-6 and 5th in points; with the record removed he'd rank 5th at 16.1%, but his playoff chance is down to 40.3%.
- **Lauren (4.6%):** 4-3 after the league's top Week 7 score, with a 76.9% playoff chance. Rice, Monangai, Egbuka and Wicks are all Week 8 questions.
- **Avery (0.0%):** 0-7 and last in all 12 runs, with a 0.5% playoff chance. Barkley, Smith and Golden are Week 8 questions.

Data checks

- **D/ST scoring:** all 93 defense scores in Weeks 1–7 match a recount from Sleeper's raw stats (0 mismatches). Six are zeros: five are bye weeks (KC in Week 5, MIN and CIN in Week 6, WAS and JAX in Week 7), and the Raiders' Week 5 zero is a real score the recount confirms.
- **Data source:** rosters, byes and projections came through Raghav's gateway MCP (`sleeper-draft__export_league_snapshot`, sha256-verified), taken after Wednesday's waivers ran. The direct-API fallback was not used.
- **Caveats:** rosters are frozen from here (no waivers or trades). Injury news was checked before Wednesday's practice reports, so Week 8 game-time decisions are scored as partial chances: Smith, Robinson, Rice and Monangai 0.3; Charbonnet and Pierce 0.4; Golden, Warren, Price, Egbuka and Wicks 0.5; Jones 0.55; Waddle 0.6; Hall and McConkey 0.65; Barkley and Love 0.7; Moore 0.8; Lamar and St. Brown 0.9. Most of these are low-confidence.